Community energy grant — conditions of award

To: Harrow Lane Community Solar Cooperative, Mill Row, Fenwick Valley

The council has awarded your cooperative a capital grant of £48,500 towards the installation of rooftop solar panels on the community hall and the primary school. The grant is offered on the conditions below, which form part of the funding agreement signed by both parties.

Use of the grant

The grant may be spent only on the equipment, installation work and connection fees listed in the approved budget. Any change to the budget of more than ten per cent of a single line needs the written consent of the project officer before the money is committed.

Accounts and claims

Recipients must submit audited annual accounts for each year in which grant money is spent, together with a statement that lists every payment made from the grant, the supplier, the date and the purpose of the payment. The statement must be signed by two members of the board, one of whom is the treasurer, and must reach the council within four months of the end of the financial year. Where the accounts show that part of the grant has not been used for the approved purpose, the council may ask for that part to be repaid or may deduct it from any later instalment.

Claims are paid within thirty days of receiving a complete claim form with copies of the supplier invoices. Claims received after 15 May 2027 will not be paid.

The cooperative must keep all invoices, contracts and bank statements relating to the project for six years after the final payment and make them available to the council’s auditors on request.

Reporting

Progress reports are due quarterly and describe the work completed, the energy generated and any problems that may delay the project. Late reports may delay the second instalment. The council’s project officer may visit the site with reasonable notice to check that the equipment has been installed as described in the application.

Publicity

The cooperative will acknowledge the council’s support on its website and on a plaque at each installation. The wording of the plaque is agreed with the council’s communications team before it is ordered.

Ending the agreement

The council may withhold or recover the grant if the cooperative breaks these conditions, gives false information or stops operating the installations within five years of the final payment. Before doing so, the council will explain its concerns in writing and allow at least twenty-eight days for a response.